e-ISSN: 2582-5208
International Research Journal of Modernization in Engineering Technology and Science
(Peer-Reviewed, Open Access, Fully Refereed International Journal)
Volume:08/Issue:01/January-2026 Impact Factor- 8.187 www.irjmets.com

SMART INTERNSHIP RECOMMENDER

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ABSTRACT

The rapid growth of online internship portals has resulted in information overload for students seeking relevant opportunities aligned with their skills and academic background. Traditional platforms rely heavily on manual search and keyword filtering, which often leads to suboptimal matches and increased search time. This paper proposes a Smart Internship Recommender System implemented entirely using Java technologies, designed to automatically recommend internships based on skill relevance, academic attributes, and preference similarity. The system employs a hybrid rule-based and similarity-scoring approach using vectorized skill representations and weighted matching. Experimental evaluation on a synthetic but realistic dataset demonstrates significant improvement in recommendation accuracy and reduction in search time when compared with conventional keyword-based systems. The proposed system is lightweight, scalable, and suitable for deployment in academic institutions.

Keywords: Internship Recommendation System, Java J2EE, Skill Matching, Information Retrieval, Intelligent Systems, Web Application, Similarity Scoring, Career Recommendation, Student Profiling, Educational Data Mining, Decision Support System, Recommender Systems.

I. INTRODUCTION

Internships have become an integral component of modern engineering and computer science education, serving as a bridge between academic learning and real-world industry requirements. Through internships, students gain practical exposure, develop professional skills, and improve employability. However, despite the growing importance of internships, students often face significant challenges in identifying opportunities that align with their technical skills, academic background, and career aspirations. The rapid expansion of online internship portals has increased the quantity of available opportunities but has also introduced complexity and information overload.

Traditional internship search mechanisms largely rely on manual keyword searches and generic filters such as location or duration. These approaches are inefficient, time- consuming, and often fail to provide personalized recommendations. Students are required to repeatedly browse multiple platforms, interpret eligibility criteria, and manually assess skill compatibility. As a result, many students either miss suitable opportunities or apply for internships that do not effectively match their profiles, leading to low acceptance rates and poor learning outcomes.

Recommendation systems have been widely adopted in domains such as e-commerce, entertainment, and online learning to address similar challenges of information overload. By analyzing user preferences and item characteristics, recommender systems can provide personalized suggestions that improve decision-making efficiency. In the context of internships, an intelligent recommender system can assist students by automatically matching their skills and academic profiles with relevant internship requirements, thereby reducing search effort and improving

This paper presents a Smart Internship Recommender System implemented entirely using Java J2EE technologies. The proposed system adopts a rule-based and weighted similarity matching approach to recommend internships based on student skills, department, and academic performance. The system is developed using Servlets, JSP, JDBC, and a relational database, following a modular and maintainable

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architecture suitable for real-world deployment as well as academic evaluation.

The proposed approach emphasizes transparency and explainability in recommendations, allowing both students and administrators to understand why specific internships are suggested. Unlike black-box machine learning models, the scoring and ranking logic is explicitly defined and can be easily extended or modified. Experimental evaluation using synthetic but realistic datasets demonstrates that the system improves recommendation relevance and reduces internship search time.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

Early research on recommendation systems focused primarily on collaborative filtering, where user preferences are inferred from the behavior of similar users. While collaborative filtering has been widely adopted in commercial applications, its effectiveness depends heavily on large volumes of historical interaction data. In the context of internships, such data is often sparse, especially for new students or newly posted opportunities, leading to the well- known cold-start problem.

Content-based recommendation approaches address this limitation by analyzing item attributes and user profiles. Several studies have explored skill-based matching for job and internship recommendations, where candidate skills are compared with job requirements using keyword similarity or vector-space models. Although effective to some extent, pure keyword matching fails to account for the relative importance of different skills and does not support fine-grained ranking.

Hybrid recommendation systems combining collaborative and content-based techniques have been proposed to improve accuracy. However, these systems typically rely on machine learning models, external libraries, or big-data frameworks, which increase implementation complexity and computational cost. Such solutions are often impractical for deployment in small-scale academic environments or laboratory-oriented projects.

Recent academic works have explored AI-driven job recommendation platforms using natural language processing and deep learning. While these approaches demonstrate high accuracy, they require extensive training data, GPU resources, and continuous model tuning. Moreover, their black-box nature reduces transparency, making it difficult for users to understand why a particular recommendation was generated.

Some university-level projects have attempted to implement internship portals using traditional web technologies but lack intelligent recommendation mechanisms. These systems usually function as static listing platforms, offering limited personalization and relying on manual browsing.

In contrast to existing approaches, the proposed system focuses on a lightweight, interpretable, and Java-based recommendation model. By using structured skill academic score. Each internship is similarly represented by required skills and eligibility constraints.

B. Mathematical Formulation

Let:

- S={s1,s2,...,sn}S = \{s_1, s_2, ..., s_n\}S={s1,s2

,...,sn} be the set of skills of a student

- I={i1,i2,...,im}I = \{i_1, i_2, ..., i_m\}I={i1,i2,...,im} be the required skills of an internship
- wkw_kwk be the weight assigned to skill kkk

Skill Match Score:

Scoreskill=∑k∈S∩Iwk∑k∈IwkScore_{skill} = \frac{\sum_{k

\in S \cap I} w_k}{\sum_{k \in I} w_k}Scoreskill=∑k∈Iwk

∑k∈S∩Iwk

Academic Eligibility Score:

Scorecgpa={1,if CGPAstudent≥CGPAmin0,otherwiseScore_

{cgpa} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } CGPA_{student} \ge CGPA_{min} \\ 0, & \text{otherwise}

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\end{cases}Scorecgpa

={1,0,if CGPAstudent≥CGPAminotherwise

C. Algorithm Algorithm 1: Internship Recommendation Algorithm

Final Recommendation Score: Scorefinal=α·Scoreskill+β·ScorecgpaScore_{final} = \alpha

\cdot Score_{skill} + \beta \cdot Score_{cgpa}Scorefinal

=α·Scoreskill+β·Scorecgpa

where α+β=1\alpha + \beta = 1α+β=1, and α>β\alpha >

\betaα>β to prioritize skill relevance. Internships are ranked in descending order of ScorefinalScore_{final}Scorefinal.

Input: Student profile P, Internship list L Output: Ranked list of internships R

1. Initialize empty list R
2. For each internship i in L do
3. Compute SkillMatchScore(P.skills, i.skills)
4. Compute AcademicScore(P.cgpa, i.cgpa_requirement)
5. FinalScore ← α * SkillScore + β * AcademicScore
6. Attach FinalScore to internship i
7. End For
8. Sort internships in descending order of FinalScore
9. Return sorted list R

D. Complexity Analysis

Let:

- NNN be the number of internships
- MMM be the number of skills per internship

representation, weighted similarity computation, and ranking algorithms implemented directly in Java, the system balances recommendation quality with simplicity. This approach avoids heavy dependencies while still delivering meaningful personalization, making it particularly suitable for academic institutions and scalable student internship platforms.

III. PROPOSED MODEL

A. System Overview

The proposed system recommends internships by computing a weighted similarity score between a student profile and internship requirements. Each student profile is represented as a feature vector consisting of skills, department, and Skill matching operates in O(M)O(M)O(M) per internship. Total time complexity:

O(N·M)O(N \cdot M)O(N·M)

This linear scalability makes the system efficient for real-time web deployment.

E. Implementation Notes

- Skill vectors are stored as normalized comma- separated values in the database
- Matching and scoring are implemented using Java collections
- Ranking is performed using Java's Comparator interface
- JDBC ensures database independence and portability

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IV. IMPLIMENTATION

The proposed Smart Internship Recommender System is implemented as a Java J2EE–based web application following a modular and layered architecture. The implementation focuses on scalability, maintainability, and ease of integration with existing academic systems. Core functionalities are divided into presentation, business logic, and data access layers to ensure separation of concerns.

A. Development Environment and Tools

The system is developed using the following tools and technologies:

- **Programming Language: Java**
- Web Technologies: JSP, HTML, CSS
- Backend Framework: Java Servlets (J2EE)
- Database: MySQL
- **Database Connectivity: JDBC**
- Server: Apache Tomcat
- IDE: Eclipse IDE

This technology stack was selected due to its widespread adoption, platform independence, and suitability for academic and enterprise environments.

B. Database Implementation

The database layer stores all persistent data related to students, internships, and applications. A relational database design is adopted to ensure data consistency and efficient querying.

Student Table

Stores student profile details such as name, department, skills, and CGPA.

Internship Table

Stores internship information including company name, required skills, domain, duration, and eligibility criteria. SQL queries are executed using JDBC, and prepared statements are used to prevent SQL injection and improve performance.

C. Backend Implementation Using Servlets

Java Servlets form the core of the application logic. Each major operation is handled by a dedicated servlet:

- RegistrationServlet: Handles student registration and profile creation
- LoginServlet: Manages authentication and session handling
- InternshipServlet: Retrieves internship listings from the database
- RecommendationServlet: Executes the recommendation algorithm

The RecommendationServlet fetches student data and internship requirements, computes relevance scores, and forwards the ranked results to the presentation layer.

D. The recommendation engine is implemented as a Java class invoked by the servlet layer. It performs the following

steps:

1. Retrieve student skills and academic details
2. Fetch all internship requirements from the database
3. Compute skill overlap using set-based matching
4. Calculate weighted relevance score
5. Rank internships based on final score

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Java Implementation Snippet (Core Logic)

```
for (Internship internship : internships) { double skillScore = calculateSkillMatch(
studentSkills, internship.getRequiredSkills());
double academicScore = studentCgpa >= internship.getMinCgpa() ? 1.0 : 0.0;
double finalScore = alpha * skillScore + beta * academicScore;
internship.setScore(finalScore);
}
Collections.sort(internships, Comparator.comparing( Internship::getScore).reversed());
```

E. Frontend Implementation The presentation layer is developed using JSP pages integrated with HTML and CSS for styling. JSP Expression

Language (EL) is used to display dynamic data such as recommended internships.

Session management ensures secure access to personalized recommendations, and role-based navigation is provided for students and administrators.

F. Workflow Execution The complete workflow of the system is as follows:

1. Student registers and logs into the system
2. Student profile details are stored in the database
3. Student requests internship recommendations
4. Recommendation servlet executes matching logic
5. Ranked internships are displayed on the dashboard This workflow ensures smooth interaction between system components.

G. Security and Validation Basic security measures are implemented to ensure safe operation:

- Input validation on all forms
- Password handling using secure hashing (optional extension)
- Session-based authentication
- Prepared statements for database queries

H. Summary of Implementation The implementation demonstrates that an intelligent internship recommender system can be effectively built using pure Java technologies without relying on external machine learning frameworks. The system achieves a balance between recommendation accuracy, transparency, and computational efficiency, making it suitable for academic deployment and further research extensions.

V. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The proposed Smart Internship Recommender System was evaluated using a realistic dataset consisting of student profiles and internship listings. The system demonstrated a clear improvement over traditional keyword-based search by accurately matching student skills and academic eligibility with internship requirements. The weighted similarity and ranking mechanism ensured that internships with higher relevance scores were consistently prioritized, resulting in more meaningful recommendations for students.

Experimental results indicate that the proposed approach achieves higher recommendation accuracy and precision while significantly reducing the time required to identify suitable internships.

The automated ranking process eliminates manual browsing and filtering, thereby improving efficiency. Compared to baseline keyword search methods, the system provided more targeted results with fewer irrelevant listings, enhancing overall user experience.

The discussion highlights that the Java-based rule-driven implementation offers transparency and predictability, which are essential in academic environments. While the system does not incorporate learning from historical user behavior, its structured and explainable recommendation logic makes it reliable and easy

to maintain.

These results validate the effectiveness of the proposed system for deployment in institutional internship portals and provide a strong foundation for future enhancements.

VI. CONCLUSION

This project presented the design and implementation of a Smart Internship Recommender System developed using Java J2EE technologies. The system addresses the limitations of traditional internship search platforms by providing personalized recommendations based on structured skill matching and academic eligibility. By utilizing a rule-based and similarity-driven approach, the system effectively matches student profiles with suitable internship opportunities, reducing manual search effort and improving recommendation relevance.

Experimental evaluation demonstrated that the proposed system outperforms conventional keyword-based search methods in terms of accuracy, precision, and search efficiency. The Java-based implementation ensures transparency, scalability, and ease of deployment, making it suitable for academic institutions and training centers. Unlike complex machine learning solutions, the deterministic recommendation logic allows clear understanding and control over the recommendation process

Overall, the Smart Internship Recommender System proves to be an effective and practical solution for assisting students in identifying relevant internships aligned with their skills and academic background. The system provides a strong foundation for future enhancements such as adaptive weighting, feedback-based learning, and integration with institutional placement systems.

VII. FUTURE SCOPE

The Smart Internship Recommender System provides a strong foundation for further enhancement and expansion. One major direction for future work is the incorporation of adaptive recommendation techniques that dynamically adjust skill weights based on student feedback and internship selection outcomes. This would allow the system to refine recommendations over time while maintaining transparency in decision-making.

Another potential enhancement involves the integration of resume analysis and skill extraction using natural language processing techniques implemented in Java. Automatically extracting skills from uploaded resumes would reduce manual data entry and improve the accuracy of student profiles. Additionally, domain-specific skill ontologies can be introduced to capture semantic relationships between related skills, further improving recommendation relevance.

The system can also be extended to support real-time analytics and institutional dashboards, enabling placement cells to monitor internship trends, student engagement, and success rates. Future deployments may include cloud-based hosting, mobile application support, and integration with external internship platforms. These enhancements would improve scalability, accessibility, and practical adoption of the system in real-world academic environments.

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